

Brand of Cereal: Special K



Creative Strategy Statement:

To convince busy moms that Special K will provide health value because of the high amount of vitamins, fiber, and the low quantities of fat, while also remaining tasty and affordable to the masses.

Target Audience:

The target audience of Special K is young-to-middle aged (20s to 50s) moms, with around 1-2 children, with a high school level education in the Northern US. They work a 9-5 job and make around 25000 to 50000 dollars a year, and would buy Special K for both themselves and their kid/s. They work hard and diligently, are very concerned about their own and their kid's health, lack the time to make full breakfasts due to their job, enjoy exercise and nature, and are generally cautious about the contents of their food, but aren't put off by sugar, and these individuals are willing to indulge in sweets every so often.

Competition:

Special K's main competition are big name cereal brands that focus on health, such as Cheerios or Chex. Special K, despite being a brand that focuses on health, suffers from the issue of a high sugar content causing it to be considered an 'ultra-processed' food, which causes healthier brands to be able to compete with Special K. Special K does have the advantage of being very well known, which gives it an edge over healthier but lesser-known cereal brands such as Kashi, plus the additional benefit that more well-known brands like Special K typically can afford to be cheaper in cost. Special K also competes with other 'premium' cereal brands such as Seven Sundays or Surreal, as Special K's ultra-processed nature once again proves to be a weakness in this market, but in exchange Special K is cheaper than its alternatives, while having the notoriety to compete. Lastly, Special K massively competes with other 'wheat flake' cereals, such as Nature's Path and Wheaties, as this type of cereal is one of the most common types of cereal, to the point that pretty much every store has a store brand of this type of cereal. Special K remains

competitive in this overflowing market with its variety of flavors that very few brands have, such as Fruits & Yogurt and Chocolate + Strawberry.

What Does Your Target Currently Think?:

Many think of the brand as a healthy low-fat vitamin rich premium cereal, with quality ingredients. Some of the target demographic, however, may think of it as less healthy than its alternatives due to its high sugar content.

What Do You Want Your Target Market to Think?:

I want Special K to be thought of as healthy in every way possible, and perhaps be seen as more affordable, given the primary demographic of working class moms. We want it to be made clear that Special K strives to make lives better and healthier through its cereal.

Why Buy:

Special K is a great buy thanks to the large varieties of types of cereals (chocolate, strawberry, etc.), great health value, and is pretty luxurious compared to most cereals at a good price, with most online listings being under \$5.

One Thing:

The one thing that people should know about the brand is that ‘Special K is here for a healthier you.’

Positioning:

Special K is positioned as a healthy and premium cereal brand thanks to its high fiber and vitamin/mineral content and its low fat content, with many different variants for you to choose from.

USB (Unique Selling Benefit):

The Unique Selling Benefit of Special K is the hefty amount of vitamins and minerals; with it being marketed as containing 11 total vitamins and minerals, something few cereals can say about themselves.

Brand Character / Personality:

The brand gives off the personality of an easy-going health guru. It's there to help you out and keep you healthy, but still knows how to have fun. I'd describe the brand as chill, light-hearted, but also hard-working and focused. I feel as though straying from this too far would certainly damage the brand's image, however that doesn't mean there aren't ways to play with this image without damaging it.

Tone:

The tone of the messaging should be a mixture of chaos and calm. The overall messaging when it comes to wording should be communicated in an honest, easygoing, quiet, and sagely tone. This should contrast against chaos and utterly bizarre things occurring around this 'guru', with them even partaking in the chaos without raising their tone. Messaging like this would communicate a feeling of 'going with the flow', while being comedic, all while not shattering the brand's image. Messaging like this would certainly appeal to the target demographic of moms who are too busy to make healthy breakfasts for their kid/s; the chaos being representative of the early morning rush, and gives off the idea the the brand understands this and is showing them that with Special K, health doesn't need to be a rush. Messaging like this would also have the major advantage of appealing to children who typically like 'busier' ads, which given the target demographic would be imperative to appeal to.

Media to be Used:

The best media types to use would be social media, especially Youtube, to potentially create a short animated series following a similar concept to the messaging mentioned above; chaos in juxtaposition to calmness. The animated series would be hosted on YouTube (where there's no restrictive subscriptions necessary to watch content), and would be advertised on other social media platforms, both in announcements and in short clips of the proposed series edited into shortform content. This animated series would start with a pilot episode to test the concept (and to minimize losses in the chance it goes poorly), and if received well enough can receive a full 12 episode season. This series would feature a guru trying to find a healthy and tasty cereal to save the lands before a plague of unhealthiness hits the country, and he'd be joined by many in his quest. To really add to the chaos aspect, the art style would be done in a style I like to call 'Cohesive Chaos', where art is drawn in many styles in a way that looks interesting rather than out of place, for example, using hand drawing people onto a stock image; a style that, if done well, looks extremely strange and chaotic in a way that gives it charm. Doing this would create an opportunity for parents to spend their time with their kids watching the series, which would allow us to target our primary demographic of moms and their children.